What Dad Owns and Whose Name Is on It

A baseline worksheet to fill in with him.

Ask three people in your family what Dad owns and you'll hear three lists, none with a date on it. This page is for making one.

Fill it in with Dad, over a visit or two. For each thing, write what it is, whose name is on it, and where you got that from: the deed, a statement, or someone's memory. Where you don't know, write “not sure” and leave the blank showing.

Plain descriptions are enough. No account numbers, Social Security numbers or passwords need to go on this page.

The home and any other real estate

The address, whose name is on the deed, and who lives there. Copy the names as the deed shows them if you have it. If you're going from memory, say so.

FOR EXAMPLE The house on Maple Street. Dad says the deed is in his name. Nobody has looked at it in years; he thinks it's in the safe-deposit box.

Cash, savings and investments

Checking and savings accounts, certificates of deposit, investment accounts. For each one: where it's held, whose name is on it, and whether that came from a statement or from memory.

FOR EXAMPLE Checking at the credit union: Dad's name, and he thinks Karen was added a few years ago to help with the bills. Not sure. Look at the next statement together.

Retirement accounts, insurance and annuities

Each account or policy on its own line, with the company, whose name it's in, and the named beneficiary if a form or statement shows it.

FOR EXAMPLE Retirement account from his old employer. Beneficiary: Dad isn't sure who he put down. Form not found yet.

Personal property and business interests

Vehicles, anything of particular value, and any share in a business or partnership. Leave this blank if there's nothing to write.

FOR EXAMPLE The truck, title in Dad's name. A share in the shop with his brother; nobody in the family has seen the paperwork.

What we don't know yet

Every “not sure” from above, with who will look it up. Looking something up doesn't require deciding anything.

FOR EXAMPLE Whose names are on the credit union account. Whether the deed is where Dad thinks it is. David will go to the bank with him next month.

Who filled this in, and the date

What this shows you

Three things: what Dad owns, whose name is on each thing as far as you can tell, and what you still need to look up. The page stops at the list. It has no column for protected, countable or exposed, and nothing here adds up to a total or a score. How any of it may be treated depends on the rules in Dad's state, which vary and change, and those questions go to your Medicaid planner or an elder law attorney. Nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You've written down what Dad owns and whose name is on it, with the blanks showing. The planning interview picks up from there: it asks about your family's situation, including the parts you didn't think to write down, and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for care.

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